

SECL: Powering India's Growth Through Sustainable Mining



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SECL has emerged as one of India's leading coal producers. How do you assess the company's performance in recent years?

SECL continues to play a critical role in India's energy security, contributing nearly 18% of the country's total coal production. FY 2025-26 was a landmark year as we achieved coal production of 176.2 million tonnes, dispatch of 178.6 million tonnes, and a record overburden removal of 364.3 million cubic metres. Rail dispatch grew by 16%, while dispatch through First Mile Connectivity (FMC) systems increased by 28%, reflecting significant improvements in logistics and operational efficiency. A notable achievement was that SECL emerged as the only subsidiary of Coal India Limited to register positive growth simultaneously in coal production, dispatch and overburden removal. These results demonstrate the strength of our mine planning, technological adoption and the dedication of our workforce.

Sustainability and ESG have become central to the mining sector. What is SECL's vision in this area?

At SECL, ESG is not a separate initiative but an integral part of our business strategy. Our vision is built around three pillars—sustainable mining operations, community-centric development and transparent governance.

Environmental stewardship is embedded across the mining lifecycle. Since inception, SECL has planted over 3 crore saplings and continues to undertake scientific mine reclamation, biodiversity conservation and eco-restoration initiatives. Through digital platforms, real-time monitoring and technology-enabled decision-making, we are also strengthening governance, transparency and operational efficiency.

What are the major sustainability initiatives currently being undertaken by SECL?

Environmental restoration through scientific mine closure, land reclamation and afforestation remains one of our top priorities. We are transforming mined-out areas into green landscapes while promoting ecological balance around our operations.

Water conservation and renewable energy are also key focus areas. During FY 2025-26, SECL utilized over 408 lakh kilolitres of mine water for industrial, domestic and agricultural purposes, benefiting more than 140 villages. We have also set a target of developing 700 MW of solar power capacity by FY 2028-29 and have already commissioned over 43 MW of solar projects.

How does SECL balance increasing coal production with environmental responsibility?

Coal continues to be essential for India's energy security, and SECL is committed to ensuring that mining activities are carried out responsibly. Our focus is on making mining cleaner, safer and more efficient through the adoption of advanced technologies.

We are increasingly deploying surface miners, continuous miners, closed conveyor systems and silo-based loading infrastructure to reduce dust emissions, fuel consumption and environmental disturbances. Continuous environmental monitoring, dust suppression systems and renewable energy initiatives further support our commitment to sustainable mining.

What are SECL's production and infrastructure targets for the future?

SECL has set an ambitious target of increasing coal production to 245 million tonnes by FY 2029-30. To support this growth, we are making significant investments in infrastructure, technology and coal evacuation systems.

Our First Mile Connectivity infrastructure already has a capacity of 151 million tonnes per annum, while dedicated rail corridors through joint ventures such as CERL and CEWRL will provide over 340 kilometres of rail connectivity and significantly enhance evacuation efficiency while reducing environmental impact.

Safety remains a critical issue in mining. How is SECL strengthening workplace safety?

Safety remains our highest priority. We have implemented robust safety systems across our operational areas through technology adoption, continuous monitoring, training programmes and regular safety audits.

SECL has also become the first coal PSU in India to implement paste-fill technology in underground mining, contributing to safer and more sustainable operations. Increased mechanization and deployment of continuous miners are reducing human exposure to hazardous environments and supporting our vision of a zero-harm workplace.

SECL has undertaken several